

DATA VORTEX A'26 — ROUND 3

Analytical Report

Public Reaction to a Platform Monetisation Change

Platform Focus: X (Twitter)

Data Source: Public YouTube comments collected through YouTube Data API v3

Final analytical sample: 40 comments from 12 videos

Analysis period: 05 Aug 2026 – 10 Sep 2026

This report analyzes the collected public reaction surrounding discussions of X monetisation changes. The analysis combines the sentiment model developed during Round 2 with time-based analysis, comment engagement analysis, and keyword-based topic/entity analysis.

1. Data Collection Method

The data collection pipeline used the YouTube Data API v3 to identify public videos discussing X monetisation and related creator-reward changes. Search queries included X monetisation change, X monetisation 2026, X creator monetisation, X creator revenue sharing, and X Original Content Rewards.

For each relevant video, publicly available comment metadata was collected together with publication timestamps, comment likes, reply counts, video statistics, channel information, search query, source, and video URL.

Initial collection: 326 comments from 39 videos.

Final analytical dataset: 40 comments from 12 videos.

The filtering process removed unrelated platform content, irrelevant comments, promotional material, generic low-information reactions, and other comments that did not contribute meaningfully to analysis of the assigned topic. The raw collection was retained separately to preserve traceability.

2. Time Window

The final analytical comments span from **05 August 2026, 09:02 UTC** to **10 September 2026, 22:08 UTC**.

The original API collection continued beyond the final analytical date, but comments collected later did not survive the relevance and manual-review process. Therefore, the report uses the final retained dataset's actual time window rather than claiming coverage of the entire raw collection period.

3. Sentiment Analysis

The Round 2 DistilBERT sentiment model was applied directly to the 40 final comments. The model produced three labels: Negative, Neutral, and Positive.

Sentiment	Comments	Percentage
Negative	7	17.5%
Neutral	26	65.0%
Positive	7	17.5%

The sample contains 26 Neutral, 7 Positive, and 7 Negative predictions. The average prediction confidence was 0.6760. Neutral was the largest category, indicating that much of the collected discussion consisted of questions, requests for information, and informational reactions rather than explicitly positive or negative statements.

Model limitation: These labels are model predictions, not manually verified ground truth. Short, multilingual, slang-heavy, and context-dependent comments may be difficult for the model to classify reliably.

3.1 Observed Sentiment Shift — August

From Aug 8 to Aug 13, the collected comments move from a positive/mixed sentiment balance toward more negative or concern-oriented predictions. On Aug 8, the dataset contains 4 Positive and 5 Neutral comments with no Negative predictions. By Aug 11, one Negative and one Neutral prediction were recorded, and Aug 13 contains one Negative prediction.

The comments during this period include concerns from small creators, questions about the new requirements, and reactions to payout and eligibility changes. Because several later dates contain only one or two comments, this is reported as an observed shift in the collected sample rather than a population-level conclusion.

3.2 Observed Sentiment Shift — September

On Sep 6, the retained dataset contains one Neutral comment. By Sep 10, seven comments are present: six Neutral and one Negative. The resulting sentiment balance moves from 0 to -14.29 percentage points.

The Sep 10 discussion is dominated by questions about eligibility, impressions, account configuration, and monetisation access. This represents a weaker shift toward concern/question-oriented discussion rather than a large explicit negative reaction.

4. Activity Analysis

Across the final sample, total comment engagement was **94**. Mean comment engagement was **2.35**, median engagement was **1.50**, and the maximum was **15**.

An engagement spike was defined objectively as a comment engagement value at or above mean + 2 standard deviations. The calculated threshold was **8.32**.

Date	Engagement	Video	Observed Reaction
2026-08-08 15:17	15	X Monetization Just Changed... Again!	I've been waiting for your video on this Sir
2026-08-08 18:33	10	X Monetization Just Changed... Again!	monetized creators now will get 4-5x or even 6x the payout amount

Both detected spikes occurred on Aug 8 under the video "X Monetization Just Changed... Again!". One high-engagement comment expressed anticipation for information about the change, while another discussed potential payout effects. These comments indicate heightened interaction around the monetisation-change discussion.

The payout multiple mentioned in the second comment is treated only as a commenter claim. It is not independently verified by this analysis.

5. Topic / Entity Analysis

A transparent keyword-based approach was used to identify recurring topics and named entities in the final comments. Categories are not mutually exclusive; one comment can match multiple categories.

Category	Topic / Entity	Comments	Share
Topic	Eligibility & Access	11	27.5%
Topic	Original Content & Reposts	10	25.0%
Topic	Monetisation Rules	6	15.0%
Topic	Payouts & Earnings	5	12.5%
Topic	Impressions & Reach	5	12.5%
Topic	Small Creators	4	10.0%
Entity	X / Twitter	10	25.0%
Entity	Pakistan	6	15.0%
Entity	500K Impressions	3	7.5%
Entity	Original Content Rewards	2	5.0%
Entity	Elon Musk	1	2.5%

The most frequently detected topic was **Eligibility & Access** with 11 comments, followed by **Original Content & Reposts** with 10 comments. Monetisation Rules, Payouts & Earnings, Impressions & Reach, and Small Creators were also recurring themes.

Among named entities, Pakistan appeared in 6 comments, 500K Impressions in 3 comments, Original Content Rewards in 2 comments, and Elon Musk in 1 comment. X/Twitter references were detected in 10 comments under the configured entity keyword rules.

6. Trigger Explanations

Trigger 1 — Monetisation-change announcement: The highest-engagement comments were concentrated on Aug 8 under a video specifically discussing the monetisation change. The comments show strong interest in understanding the new system and its implications.

Trigger 2 — Eligibility and access: Repeated comments discussed whether particular countries, accounts, or creator types could participate. Pakistan was a recurring entity in this discussion.

Trigger 3 — Original content and reposts: Several comments focused on what content would qualify and how reposting or engagement-oriented behaviour would be treated.

Trigger 4 — Creator thresholds: Comments repeatedly asked about impressions, verified followers, reach, and other requirements, indicating that creators were trying to understand how to meet the new or discussed monetisation conditions.

7. Key Findings

- Neutral sentiment was the largest model-predicted sentiment category.
- Eligibility & Access was the most frequent detected topic.
- Original Content & Reposts was the second most frequent detected topic.
- The strongest engagement concentration occurred on Aug 8.
- Both detected engagement spikes were associated with a video discussing the monetisation change.
- The collected discussion contained substantial questions about eligibility, impressions, payouts, reposts, and small-creator participation.
- The temporal analysis shows observable changes in the composition of the collected comments, but the small daily sample sizes limit generalisation.

8. Limitations

- The dataset represents public YouTube commenters discussing X monetisation and is not a representative sample of all X users.
- The final analytical dataset contains only 40 comments.
- Some dates contain very few comments, making daily sentiment percentages unstable.
- The Round 2 model was trained on a separate labelled dataset and may have reduced reliability on multilingual or slang-heavy comments.
- Keyword-based topic detection is transparent but may miss implicit topics and can assign multiple categories to one comment.
- Comments containing claims about payouts, eligibility, or platform rules were not independently verified.
- Search-result based collection can introduce source-selection bias because the available videos influence which public comments are observed.

9. Conclusion

The collected sample shows that public discussion around the X monetisation change was primarily concerned with eligibility and access, original-content and repost rules, monetisation requirements, payouts, impressions, and small-creator participation. The highest engagement occurred around Aug 8 in comments responding to a video focused specifically on the monetisation change.

The Round 2 DistilBERT model provided a consistent sentiment classification framework, while time-based analysis showed observable shifts in the composition of the collected discussion. Because the final dataset is small and source-specific, the findings should be interpreted as patterns in the collected public comments rather than as

estimates of the sentiment of all X users.